EXECUTIVE AI BRIEFING

AI LEADERSHIP • GOVERNANCE • BUSINESS VALUE

Eight AI Governance Controls

The Executive Operating Guide to Lead AI Safely and at Scale

WHAT TO CONTROL • HOW TO LEAD • WHAT IT TAKES TO GET IT DONE

THE EXECUTIVE PERSPECTIVE | AI creates value when it is **governed in practice** — with clear ownership, operational controls and ongoing proof that it works as intended.

01 AI INVENTORY

Know what you have, who owns it and why it is used.

- Register all AI systems and use cases
- Define owner, purpose and data used
- Track lifecycle and deployment status

02 RISK CLASSIFICATION

Understand what is at stake and apply the right control.

- Assess legal, operational and reputational risk
- Classify by risk tier (e.g., high, limited, minimal)
- Apply proportional controls and review when use changes

03 IMPACT ASSESSMENT

Identify and mitigates effects before deployment.

- Evaluate effects on people and customers
- Check fairness, non-discrimination and rights
- Assess privacy and data protection impact

04 TESTING & ASSURANCE

Prove it works, is robust and ready for real use.

- Test accuracy, reliability and robustness
- Run adversarial and edge-case tests
- Validate results and define go-live criteria

05 DATA CONTROLS

Ensure data is protected, trusted and traceable.

- Use approved and trusted data sources
- Enforce role-based and need-to-know access
- Maintain data lineage and retention rules

06 HUMAN OVERSIGHT

Keep people in charge of high-stakes decisions.

- Define what requires human review and approval
- Set a clear escalation and override path
- Enable a stop (kill switch) for safety and risk

07 AGENT & ACTION CONTROLS

Keep AI agents and automated actions within bounds.

- Use a unique agent identity and access profile
- Apply least privilege and transaction limits
- Add context checks (e.g., amount, recipient, timing)
- Separate duties for sensitive or irreversible actions

08 MONITORING & AUDIT

Track performance, detect issues and keep an audit trail.

- Monitor drift, quality and unusual behavior
- Keep full traceability and audit records
- Manage incidents with a clear response plan
- Run regular, independent audits and testing

HOW TO MAKE IT HAPPEN

1. **SEE THE WORK** — Build the inventory and classify risk.
2. **TEST THE CONSEQUENCES** — Assess impact and prove it works.
3. **KEEP WITHIN AUTHORITY** — Protect data and keep humans in control.
4. **CONTROL AND RENEW** — Monitor in use, audit and adjust permissions.

EXECUTIVE RELEASE GATE

- **APPROVE** — Go live as designed.
- **LIMIT** — Go live with guardrails (e.g., lower scope, tighter limits).
- **REPAIR** — Fix gaps before go-live or within a defined timeframe.
- **STOP** — Do not go live or suspend use until risks are resolved.

- **BUSINESS ACCOUNTABILITY** — Owns the outcome, risk and decision (Business Process Owner).
- **TECHNICAL ENFORCEMENT** — Implements and operates the controls (access, limits, logging, safeguards).
- **INDEPENDENT ASSURANCE** — Verifies control effectiveness (e.g., audit, risk or compliance review).

THE BOTTOM LINE | *A permitted action can still be the wrong action. Test, validate and control AI in its business context — before it executes and continuously after go-live.*



Jair Ribeiro | AI LEADER

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